



(X)TweetDelete for Linux / Debian

I call the app TweetDelete but there is another web-based service called <https://tweetdelete.net/> that has registered the name on X. Hence you may see XtweetDelete used for this desktop app in places to avoid namespace conflicts, e.g., X's developer console and authorisation process.

What does TweetDelete do?

X allows users to delete posts one at a time. This is painful if you want to delete many. Often users want to delete old posts rather than have them haunt them due to some out of context remarks or comments made in a bad mood that were forgotten about.

TweetDelete will delete your posts, replies, likes & reposts from X in bulk. For a small number of Tweets, it will do this without manual assistance using the X api, but X has limits and rate limiting. E.g., X will only allow 50 tweets to be deleted before pausing for 15 mins. It may also just stop for a very large number of tweets. For a moderate number this app will resume deleting after the 50 posts / 15 minute delay that X imposes.

If you have many thousands of tweets, it will delete as many as it can up to the limit that X allows. It will then stop and ask you to download an archive file of the tweets from X and provide it with that to find the others and delete them. This is a limitation imposed by X, it may change with time, at the time of writing the limit was 3,200 before an archive is required manually.

If you have a small number of tweets, say <50, it should do that pretty quickly in just a few seconds. If you have more it will take longer as described above.

Warning!

TweetDelete uses a helper app. This runs in the background as a service. If you ask TweetDelete to delete, say 100 tweets, and change your mind, closing the browser window will not stop it. The helper app will continue. If you stop the helper or shutdown the computer, when it restarts it will resume.

This is usually desirable behaviour to help delete large numbers with X's rate limiting. So please be sure you want to delete and that you have used the correct time period to delete.

Rationale

You might wonder why you would want to do this. We are seeing increasing surveillance and restriction on free speech. Tweets are taken out of context; police action is taken based on claimed offence. Let's face it someone, somewhere is always going to claim offence at other's opinions. We also all grow and change and for personalities & politicians the media regularly rakes up old tweets in order to embarrass, mislead and even destroy careers. It is not uncommon to say something stupid and rash in an emotional state or from lack of maturity when young.

How do you use it

**** You need an X developer account in order to obtain a client id as a credential for the app to operate **** <https://docs.x.com/fundamentals/developer-portal>

The account is free. It may seem complex and confusing if you are not an IT Geek, in which case I suggest you ask your friendly AI to walk you through the process. What is not free, is using the app. Unfortunately, X charge for all API / automated access. It is typically < \$0.01 per API request – check the latest pricing. If you ever you sit there and delete a couple of hundred tweets, paying a dollar or two to delete them looks attractive! I haven't accurately costed it but you pre-purchase X credits so you can't spend more than you have paid.

Armed with a client id, simply download the package, unzip, run the install; “sudo apt install <path to>tweetdelete_<version number>_all.deb”.

During installation 2 things will be done; a tiny server component, which is more of a proxy for the comms to X, will be installed as systemd service which will start when a user logs on. To start without logging out and in again, start the service with; “systemctl –user start tweetdelete.service”.

Launch the UI app from the graphical menu system or terminal; “tweetdelete”. It will launch and run in your default browser.

Credits

Thanks to Perplexity AI, mostly using Claude Opus 5.5, which did the heavy lifting. Not sure what agents were invoked.

Licencing

Copyright © 2026 Ian Packer.

Licensed under the PolyForm Non-commercial License 1.0.0.

Commercial use requires a separate licence from the copyright holder.

This software is provided free of charge; that might change one day but I have no plans currently. It is free to use by individuals. It will not (probably can't be) retrospectively charged if it was used in compliance with this licencing approach.

It is supplied without any warranty, guarantees or support. If you find a bug by all means email to the address below. Note: This is not my job I produced it for my own use and I am simply sharing, the risk is yours. It has not been professionally tested.

It is not licenced for use in commercial gain. If you wish to discuss such use, please email: think-1551@pm.me

Other licences may be used on distribution sites